

How is **Worry** different than **Problem-Solving**?

Worry	Problem-Solving
Worry is often automatic. It just shows up. It repeats itself; round and round; over and over.	Problem-solving is done deliberately, on purpose.
Worry shows up at the wrong times (like when you need to sleep!)	Problem-solving is done at a chosen time. Breaks are taken.
Worry is generally focused on the future. Worry is filled with predictions, guesses, mind-reading, and judgements.	Problem-solving deals mostly in "facts". Thoughts about the future, or about what others think, are treated as "possibilities".
Worry has "tunnel vision". A worried mind is stuck on <i>bad</i> outcomes, and may not see the whole picture. It overestimates how likely or how bad things will be.	Problem-solving considers a range of good, bad, and neutral possibilities.
A worried mind underestimates your ability to cope. It puts you down. It takes away your confidence.	Problem-solving builds you up through self-compassion and coaching.
Worry focuses on things you cannot control.	Problem-solving focuses on the parts of the problem over which you can have some control.
Worry is often based on rigid, all-or-nothing standards.	Problem-solving involves flexible thinking. It considers a variety of viewpoints. It does not demand perfection.
A worried mind wants certainty about what is going to happen.	Problem-solving involves acceptance of uncertainty.
Worry leads to feeling stuck; to procrastination; and to avoidance of making decisions and taking action.	Problem-solving leads to decision-making and to action in the present.